

3.2 Defined Names

You can also use Defined Names to use in your references. A Defined Name is a special, custom name you assign to a cell, a range of cells, or a range of non-adjacent cells (that

	A	B	C	D
1				
2	Area			
3	North	Sales Div 1	Sales Div 2	Sales Div 3
4	South	10,000,000.00	12,500,000.00	9,800,000.00
5	West	1,200,000.00	1,440,000.00	1,132,000.00
6	East	14,200,000.00	17,940,000.00	10,932,000.00

An example of a Named Range

is, cells that are not next to each other: you select multiple such cells by holding down [Ctrl] and clicking on each cell you want to include). This is useful especially in large and complex worksheets where you can get easily confused by just the cell references.

To create a Defined Name, select a cell, a range of cells, or a set of non-adjacent cells, and click on the left end of the Name box. (This is the box before the “fx” formula bar at the top.) Give a name for your selection and hit [Enter]. For example, in the figure, the area sales of Sales Division 1 has been selected together and given the name “SalesDiv1”.

Now, suppose you wanted the total of this list. Instead of giving a cell range reference [SUM(B3:B6)], you would simply say SUM(SalesDiv1). This will greatly simplify your tasks, especially in large, complex sheets, where it will be difficult to keep track of cell references without getting confused.

A few things to note with named ranges: the name can be any alphanumeric string of letters or numbers but without any spaces. If you want to do any mathematical or formula operations on more than one range, you will have to specify each range individually. In the above example, if you wanted the totals of all the sales divisions, you would write:

SUM(SalesDiv1)+ SUM(salesDiv2)+ SUM(salesDiv3)

and not

SUM(SalesDiv1+SalesDiv2+SalesDiv3)